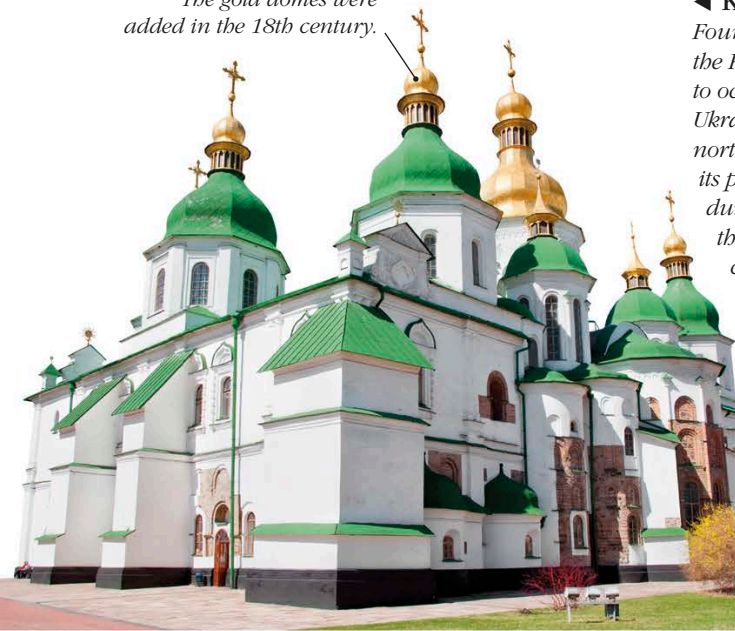


The gold domes were added in the 18th century.

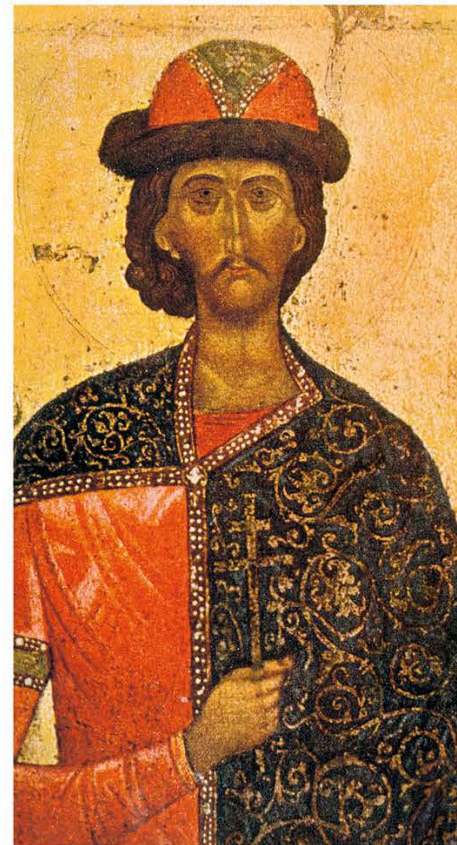


◀ KIEVAN RUS

Founded in the 9th century, the Kievan Rus was the first state to occupy lands in modern-day Ukraine and Belarus, and northwestern Russia. It reached its peak in the 11th century, during the rule of Yaroslav the Wise, who ordered the construction of St. Sophia's Cathedral in Kyiv, Ukraine.

▼ THE BULGARS

The semi-nomadic Bulgar tribe arrived in eastern Europe in the 5th century. Around 630, they united, forming Old Great Bulgaria. Their influence rose in the 9th century under Boris I (below) who expanded their territory and converted his people to Christianity.



▼ THE MAGYARS

The Magyars were tribes from the Ural mountains in western Russia. By the end of the 9th century, chieftains of the seven Magyar tribes (below) moved their people west and settled in what is now Hungary.



FACT

In 1054, the Eastern Orthodox Church formally split from the Roman Catholic Church after years of disagreements. This became known as the East-West Schism.

▼ DUŠAN'S CODE

Under Stefan Dušan (reigned 1331–1355), Serbia flourished culturally and emerged as a major power in southeastern Europe. Dušan issued a collection of laws, known as Dušan's Code (below), which covered everything from marriage contracts to how to settle disputes between peasants.

